



BY AJAY PIRAMAL

Shaping a Formidable India Together

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SINCE 1947, A multitude of leading western observers doubted the ability of India—a multicultural and poly-linguistic democracy—to survive. However, not only did we defy our sceptics in standing united and democratic to our core, but we also emerged as a global leader across aspects of multilateralism, science, technology, medicine and combating climate change. Today, it gives me immense pleasure to pen down my vision for India as we march towards our 100 years of Independence, in this *Amrit Kaal*.

In the next 25 years leading to 100 years of independent India, it is my strong belief that we stand at the cusp of making a greater impact at a global stage. It will be in the way the country

does business with the world, or by working towards becoming a powerhouse for technological innovations. In the coming time, ensuring quality healthcare and education to all its citizens will also be a key factor in boosting India's socio-economic development.

During the COP26 deliberations in 2021, India emerged as a crusader in adopting net-zero fossil fuel emission targets. We expect to cut down carbon emissions drastically over the next few years and become one of the handful of countries approaching net-zero emissions over the next 25 years.

Another area of rapid advancement for India is in biotechnology. We are global leaders in manufacturing vaccines combating numerous diseases like Diphtheria Pertussis Tetanus (DPT), measles as well as Covid-19. Today, India has the world's highest number of US Food and Drug Administration (USFDA)-approved manufacturing plants outside the US. The title of 'pharma capital of the world' can be sustained only by fuelling indigenous innovation and encouraging research and development in the sector.

In addition, adequate emphasis

needs to be given to develop sustainable practices in agriculture. Food sufficiency is key to ensure it doesn't stymie the country's progress.

India saw phenomenal growth in the last 30 years, backed by major reforms and a keen interest among global investors to be a part of the India story. Back in 1990, we accounted for only 3 per cent of the global GDP, which more than doubled to 7 per cent by 2021. I hope the next 25 years will significantly elevate India's economic activity, thereby fostering large-scale development in sync with that of a high-income advanced nation. India's economy in 25 years will be characterised by high living standards, per capita income on a par with high income nations, and we will be performing well on the Human Development Index (HDI), portraying our achievements in significantly uplifting levels of health, education and literacy for the entire Indian population. This would be achieved through a plethora of inclusive government schemes encompassing the current focus on infrastructure, skill development and manufacturing, efforts by the social sector to impact lives at the last mile, and technologies that are